

FEAR OF HUNGER

When you change your way of eating or start a new meal plan, you may assume you will be 'hungry'. Hunger can be scary, especially because it is often uncomfortable, to say the least. If you get hungry between meals or are even just nervous about being hungry between meals, keep the following in mind:

HUNGER IS OKAY

- Hunger is not an emergency! In fact, hunger is very normal. It is your body's natural way of letting you know that it's time to eat again. Continue to remind yourself it's a normal and natural feeling, and you will start to accept feelings of hunger without fear or anxiety.
- Hunger comes and goes. It may feel like your hunger will continue to increase forever, but after a bit of time, it never seems as bad.
- Have you ever been so busy you skipped a meal? How did you feel? Think about your past experiences when you weren't on a 'diet' and you accidentally skipped meals....you might have been hungry but you survived!
- Some cultures and religions include fasting as part of a holiday or ritual and routinely people go hours or days without food. With this in mind, remember that being hungry for just a few hours won't harm you.



RETHINK YOUR HUNGER

- Are you the type of person that plans your day around your eating schedule? Practice scheduling your day with activities as your main focus instead. You should feel prepared and in control of your food but not like it has control over you.
- Learn to distinguish the difference between “need” and “want.” Feeling hungry can be uncomfortable but doesn't mean you need to eat.
- “Rethinking” can be particularly helpful to remember when you feel hunger and the only food option is a poor one. You can wait to eat again until there is a better choice—you don't have to eat the pizza just because you are hungry.

NEED vs WANT

Note: Everyone's plan is different and based on personal medical history, diagnoses (such as diabetes), and medications (such as insulin). Certain symptoms related to hunger could indicate low blood sugar, which may be an issue. Always talk to your medical provider or dietitian at Pounds for more specific recommendations!